

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 4 3
♥ 5
♦ 8 6 5 2
♣ J 10 9 4

♠ 7 5 2

♥ A 10 8

♦ A 9 3

♣ A Q 8 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8

♥ K Q J 9 6 3

♦ 10 4

♣ 7 6 3

♠ A K Q 6

♥ 7 4 2

♦ K Q J 7

♣ K 5

West

North

East

South

1♣

2♥

Dbl

Pass

2NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

Lead: ♥K

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♥K, dummy plays the ♥2 and West the ♥5.

As usual, you have 11 winners; 3 ♠s, 1 ♥, 4 ♦s and 3 ♣s. If ♠s split 3-3 dummy's ♠6 will become trick #12. If ♠s don't split though, you will have the chance of a squeeze if the defender with long ♠s also has 4 or more ♣s.

For a squeeze to operate you will need to lose one trick and the time to do that is right now. Let East hold the ♥K and win his ♥ continuation with your ♥A.

West discarded a ♦ on the second ♥.

You might as well find out about the ♠s right now. Play the ♠ A K Q.

Too bad, East discards a ♥ on the third round of ♠s.

West now holds the the only guard in ♠s.

Play the ♦A, then ♦K Q.

West will follow to all three ♦s.

Now for the squeeze.

West discards.

Play dummy's ♦J and discard your last small ♥.

If West discards the ♠J you will cash dummy's ♠6, then win the last 3 ♣ tricks.

So West will no doubt throw a ♣ instead. In which case you win the last 4 ♣ tricks.

Squeezes are so very satisfying.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 5 2
 ♥ A 8 2
 ♦ Q 8 6 4
 ♣ K Q 2

♠ J 9 8 6 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ 10

♣ J 8 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A

♥ J 7 4

♦ A K J 9 7 5

♣ A 7 4

♠ K 10 7 3

♥ K Q 10 6

♦ 3 2

♣ 10 9 5

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
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2NT	Pass	4♦	Pass
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5♦	Pass	6♦	
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All Pass

6♦ by East

Lead: ♥K

East is to play 6♦. South leads the ♥K.

You have 11 winners; 1 ♠, 1 ♥, 6 ♦s and 3 ♣s.

At first things look hopeless, but remember this is a lesson on squeeze plays. From the opening lead you know that South must hold the ♥Q. If he also holds the ♠K you will be able to squeeze him in ♥s and ♠s.

You let the ♥K win, (hoping he will play another ♥), but he plays a small trump instead which you win in your hand.

Pull one more round of trumps, then unblock the ♠A.

Then take your 3 ♣ winners, ending in your hand.

Now play ♦Q, ♦J, ♦9. Discard the ♠5 from dummy on the third ♦.

South could afford to throw 2 ♠s and a ♥ on your ♦ plays.

South discards the ♥10.

When you play the ♦7 he is squeezed.

He cannot dump his ♠K because you would throw the ♥8 and dummy would be high.

So he will discard the ♥10 instead. At this point you know that the ♠Q is worthless so you discard it. You win the final two tricks with the ♥A and ♥J.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5 4 2
♥ J
♦ 9 8 4 3
♣ J 10 9 3

♠ A K J

♥ K 7 3

♦ A 6 5 2

♣ 8 6 4

N
W E
S

♠ Q 10 9 3

♥ 10 5 4

♦ K J 10

♣ A K Q

♠ 8 7

♥ A Q 9 8 6 2

♦ Q 7

♣ 7 5 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♣J

your hand.

The ♦Q was not a Threat card yet: to make it a Threat you had to unblock dummy's ♦A. Then you pull trumps with the ♥A Q.

Unblocking the ♦A to make your ♦Q a squeeze Threat is called the Vienna Coup.

With 6 cards left to be played you are ready to apply pressure to East.

Play the ♥9 8, discarding ♦s from dummy. East is not troubled yet, he can discard the ♦J and the ♠3.

East is now looking a little nervous, like he has a big target on his back!

West discards.

Play the ♥6 and throw dummy's ♦6.

East can choose his fate. If he throws the ♠9 you will know that his ♠Q will drop since his third card **MUST** be the ♦K. So you would just play to the high ♠s and the ♠J would be good.

Or, he can throw his ♦K which makes your ♦Q a winner.

That worked great, right? Let's back up and pretend you had NOT unblocked the ♦A. We will just add one ♦ to everybody's hand and look at the ending.

Now when you play your ♥6 as a squeeze card you have a problem. You are squeezing dummy, not East.

If you discard the ♦6 East will throw his ♦J, then sit back and wait for his ♠Q trick.

But if you discard dummy's ♠J instead, East will match that by throwing his ♠9, then sit back and wait for his ♦K trick.

Only by visualizing the ending and using the Vienna Coup can this hand be made.

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♣J. East wins ♣A K Q then switches to a trump.

East takes ♣A K Q then switches to a trump.

You must win the next 10 tricks but you only have 9 winners.

East opened 1NT, showing 15-17 points, and West has already produced 2 Jacks. So both the ♠Q and ♦K are with East and you will have to put the squeeze on him.

You are in dummy, having won their trump exit with the ♥K.

Since you need all the tricks the count is already rectified.

You plan to squeeze East by running the long ♥s in

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 7
 ♥ A 4
 ♦ Q 5 4
 ♣ A J 9 7 3 2

♠ J 10 6 5
 ♥ K Q J 7 5
 ♦ 9 2
 ♣ 8 4



♠ A 2
 ♥ 9 3
 ♦ A K 8 6
 ♣ K Q 10 6 5

♠ K 9 8 4 3
 ♥ 10 8 6 2
 ♦ J 10 7 3
 ♣ —

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	Pass	2 ♦	Pass
3 ♣	Pass	4 ♣	Pass
4 ♥	Pass	4 ♠	Pass
6 ♣			
All Pass			
6 ♣ by West			
Lead: ♥ K			

♠ Q is the Vienna Coup.

North discards.

South was able to find discards on your first three trump leads, but when you play the ♣ 7 and discard dummy's ♠ 2 he is squeezed.

He can see that if he discards a ♦ dummy will be high, so he will probably throw the ♠ K in hopes that his partner holds the ♠ Q. But you have that card and you make the slam.

As an afterthought to this Deal, let us suppose you were playing 6NT rather than 6♣.

The only difference would be that to rectify the count you would have to hold up once on the opening ♥ K.

West is to play 6♣. North leads the ♥ K.

You have 11 top tricks and hope for a 3-3 ♦ split to give you one more. If they don't split you can hope that the defender with 4 ♦ s also holds the ♠ K and that a squeeze will be possible.

You win the first trick and pull trumps in two rounds, ending in dummy.

In case the squeeze becomes necessary you rectify the count by giving up a ♥.

North takes the ♥ trick and plays the ♦ 9 which you win with your ♦ Q.

North plays low.

The key play: taking dummy's ♠ A before running three rounds of ♣ s.

Unblocking the ♠ A to create a Threat out of your